

ARISE

Adolescent Reproductive Health Information Support & Empowerment

MENSTRUAL HEALTH

Menstrual Health

Student Study Guide & Quiz Answer Key

Module:	Menstrual Health
Lesson:	Menstrual Health
Quiz:	25 marks (10 MCQ + 5 Fill-in-blanks + 3 Short Answer)
Pass Mark:	15/25 (60%) — Certificate awarded at 60%+
Languages:	English Kiswahili Sheng

Learning Outcomes

By the end of this lesson, you will be able to:

1. Describe the phases of the menstrual cycle
2. Identify normal and abnormal period symptoms
3. Demonstrate good menstrual hygiene practices
4. Challenge myths and address period poverty

Slide 2: Understanding the Menstrual Cycle

The menstrual cycle is a monthly hormonal process preparing the body for possible pregnancy. It is biology — not a curse.

Phase	Days	What Happens
Menstruation	1–5	Uterine lining sheds — the period bleed
Follicular Phase	1–13	Lining rebuilds, egg matures in ovary
Ovulation	~14	Mature egg released — highest fertility
Luteal Phase	15–28	Progesterone rises; lining thickens for implantation

Slide 3: Period Symptoms & What Is Normal

Knowing what is normal during menstruation helps you recognise when to seek medical help.

KEY TERM: PMS

Premenstrual Syndrome — physical and emotional symptoms (bloating, mood swings, breast tenderness) in the days before a period. Common and manageable.

Symptom	Normal?	Action
Mild cramping	■ Normal	Warm compress, paracetamol
Bloating & fatigue	■ Normal	Rest, hydrate, light exercise
PMS mood changes	■ Normal	Rest, talk to someone, exercise
Very heavy bleeding (soaking pad hourly)	■■ See doctor	Visit health facility
Severe pain stopping normal activity	■■ See doctor	Could indicate endometriosis
Period stopping for 3+ months	■■ See doctor	Rule out pregnancy, stress, illness

Slide 4: Menstrual Hygiene Management

Good menstrual hygiene protects your health, confidence, and keeps you in school.

■ ■ ■ Period Poverty Alert

■ In Kenya, 65% of women and girls cannot afford sanitary pads regularly. This causes school absenteeism. If you struggle to access pads, talk to your teacher or nurse — free pads are available at many health facilities.

Slide 5: Myths vs Facts

Dangerous myths about menstruation still spread in Kenyan communities. Know the facts.

Myth	Fact
Menstruation is a curse or punishment	It is a normal biological process
Girls cannot bathe during their period	Bathing is safe and important
Exercise makes periods worse	Light exercise reduces cramps
Girls should stay home during periods	Girls can attend school and all activities
Irregular cycles are always serious	Stress and illness can cause temporary irregularity

Wanjiku's School Club — Murang'a

Wanjiku started a 'Period Positivity' club at her school in Murang'a. They made reusable pads from fabric donations and taught 80 girls proper hygiene. School attendance during 'period week' rose by 30%. Her headteacher nominated her for a county youth award.

Slide 6: Module Video

Watch carefully, then continue to the scenarios.

Slide 7: Real Talk — What Would You Do?

Pick your choice and see the consequence.

Slide 8: Managing Period Symptoms

You do not have to suffer in silence. Here are evidence-based ways to manage period symptoms.

Symptom	Home Management	See Doctor If
Cramps	Warm compress, paracetamol, gentle walk	Pain stops normal activity
Heavy flow	Change pad every 2 hours if needed	Soaking pad every hour
PMS mood	Exercise, rest, talk to someone	Severe depression/anxiety
Irregular cycle	Track cycle — stress can cause this	Missing for 3+ months

Quiz — Answer Key

Total: 25 marks | Pass: 15/25 (60%) | Certificate at 60%+

Part A: Multiple Choice (10 marks)

1. 1. The menstrual cycle is counted from:

- ☐ A. The last day of one period to the last day of the next
- ☒ B. The first day of one period to the first day of the next
- ☐ C. The middle of one period to the middle of the next
- ☐ D. Ovulation to ovulation

2. 2. Ovulation is:

- ☐ A. The start of menstruation
- ☒ B. The release of a mature egg from the ovary
- ☐ C. The end of puberty
- ☐ D. A type of contraception

3. 3. Normal menstrual flow lasts approximately:

- ☐ A. 1–2 days
- ☒ B. 3–7 days
- ☐ C. 2–3 weeks
- ☐ D. One full month

4. 4. Dysmenorrhoea refers to:

- ☐ A. Absence of menstruation
- ☒ B. Painful menstruation (period cramps)
- ☐ C. Very heavy bleeding
- ☐ D. Irregular cycle only

5. 5. A menstrual cycle shorter than 21 days or longer than 35 days is considered:

- ☐ A. Perfectly normal for all girls
- ☒ B. Irregular and worth mentioning to a healthcare provider
- ☐ C. A sign of pregnancy
- ☐ D. Only caused by diet

6. 6. Premenstrual Syndrome (PMS) symptoms include:

- ☐ A. Only physical pain
- ☒ B. Mood changes, bloating, breast tenderness, and fatigue before the period
- ☐ C. Fever and rash
- ☐ D. Loss of appetite only

7. 7. The safest and most hygienic menstrual product for school-going girls in Kenya is:

- ☐ A. Pieces of old clothing without washing
- ☒ B. Clean disposable pads or well-maintained reusable cloth pads
- ☐ C. Leaves from the garden
- ☐ D. Tissue paper only

8. 8. Period poverty means:

- ☐ A. Earning less money during your period

☒ **B. Lack of access to menstrual products, clean water, or safe sanitation**

☐ C. A rare condition in wealthy countries only

☐ D. Spending too much on pads

9. 9. A reliable home remedy for mild period cramps is:

☐ A. Drinking very cold water only

☒ **B. Warm compress on the abdomen, gentle exercise, and staying hydrated**

☐ C. Avoiding all food

☐ D. Staying in bed for the entire period

10. 10. Menstruation is a sign that a girl's body:

☐ A. Is sick

☐ B. Is cursed

☒ **C. Is functioning normally and is reproductively maturing**

☐ D. Needs immediate medical attention always

Part C: Short Answer (25 marks)

1. 1. The average menstrual cycle lasts _____ days, but 21–35 days is considered normal. (3 marks)

2. 2. The release of a mature egg from the ovary is called _____. (3 marks)

3. 3. Painful periods are medically called _____. (3 marks)

4. 4. Physical and emotional symptoms before a period are collectively called _____. (3 marks)

5. 5. Lack of access to menstrual products and clean sanitation is called period _____. (3 marks)

6. Describe the four main phases of the menstrual cycle in order. (3 marks marks) (3 marks)

7. Explain TWO effects of period poverty on a school-going girl's life and suggest ONE solution. (4 marks marks) (4 marks)

8. A classmate says 'I can't exercise or bathe during my period — it makes it worse.' Is she correct? Explain. (3 marks marks) (3 marks)